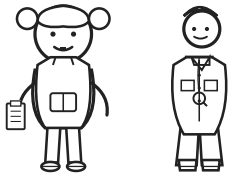
Slow Looking: Notice Three Small Things

Adult guide · Ages 4–8 · 15 minutes · “The Naturalist Visits”



In the cartoon, Mira is always in a hurry. Mr. Quill, a quiet naturalist, shows her how to look slowly. This activity lets children try the same thing. You don't need any training. Just go slowly yourself.

Word of the day

notice

When you notice something, you see it because you looked slowly and carefully. Small things show up when you wait.

Say it together: “I noticed it!”

WHAT YOU NEED

- The 4-minute cartoon “The Naturalist Visits” on any screen
- One observation sheet for each child (black and white is fine)
- Pencils or crayons
- Optional: a magnifying glass
- Optional: a few small things to look at, like a leaf, a pebble or a shell

STEPS

1. **Watch** (4 min). Watch the cartoon together. Before you press play, say: “Let’s see what Mira notices.”
2. **Talk** (4 min). Say the word of the day together. Then ask the three questions below. Wait a little before you help. Every answer is welcome.
3. **Look and draw** (5 min). Each child picks one small spot: a plant, a windowsill, the floor, their own sleeve. Look slowly, as long as it takes a cloud to move. Then draw one small thing in each box.
4. **Share** (2 min). Each child shows one drawing. Ask: “What did you see when you looked a little longer?”

TALK ABOUT IT

1. At the Window Out

Mira looked fast and saw only leaves. Mr. Quill looked slowly. What did he see?

Listen for: A drop of water, a fern bending, a tiny brown beetle.

2. On the Comfort Couch

Mira found the lost page, but Mr. Quill still didn't feel done. What did Mira do to help him?

Listen for: She stopped rushing, sat still next to him and listened.

3. At the very end

What tiny thing did Mira notice all by herself? Where could you look for a tiny thing today?

Listen for: A little gray moth on a bin she walked past every day. Any place nearby is a good answer.

CHILDREN WHO CAN'T READ YET

For children who can't read yet: read the sheet out loud and point to each box. Ask them to tell you about each drawing, and write their words under it. Very young children can point and name things instead of drawing.

TIPS

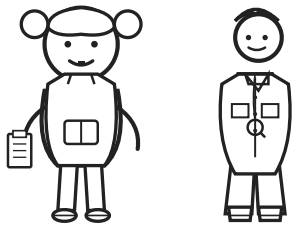
- Quiet pauses are part of the activity. You don't need to fill them.
- Praise the looking, not the drawing. There are no wrong answers.
- Indoors works too: a crumb, a crack in the floor, a bit of fluff.
- In a class, children can work in pairs: one looks, one whispers what they see.

Know another parent or teacher? Share this free activity: **https://cartoons.luispereira.me/en/the-naturalist-visits/slow-looking/**

Characters: Mira & Mr. Pemberton Quill from “The Naturalist Visits”. Line art from the luiscper-cartoons picture-book-flat character parts.

I noticed three small things

Look slowly. Draw one small thing in each box.



My name: _____

Where I looked: _____

Small thing 1

What it is (a grown-up can write it):

Small thing 2

What it is (a grown-up can write it):

Small thing 3

What it is (a grown-up can write it):

The thing I looked at the longest was…

_____

Know another parent or teacher? Share this free activity: **https://cartoons.luispereira.me/en/the-naturalist-visits/slow-looking/**